



Swimming Carnival

Safety Briefing

Read this before you enter the water. It will take 2 minutes and could save a life.

Today's Rules — Everyone Must Know These



Stay in your designated area. Only enter the water when instructed by your teacher or event marshal. Do not enter the warm-up or racing lanes unless it is your turn.



No diving in shallow water. Check depth before any entry. Feet-first entry only unless you are in a designated dive start lane confirmed by staff.



Always have a buddy. Know who your buddy is. If you can't see them, tell a teacher immediately.



Signal for help if you need it. Raise ONE arm. Do not be embarrassed — it is always better to ask for help.



Phones away near the pool edge. Distraction is a major factor in pool incidents. Phones are for spectator areas only.



Medical conditions. If you have asthma, a heart condition, or any health issue — check in with your teacher before the carnival begins. Do not swim if you feel unwell.



No running on the pool deck. Walk at all times. Wet pool decks cause falls that result in serious injuries every year.



Know These Locations

- **First aid station:** _____
(teacher to fill in)
- **AED (defibrillator):** _____
- **Emergency exit:** _____
- **Teacher in charge:** _____
- **Lifeguard on duty:** _____



Before You Swim

- Know your event number and heat
- Have goggles & swim cap ready
- Apply sunscreen (outdoor pool)
- Stay hydrated — drink water regularly
- Warm up gently — no cold water shock
- Tell your teacher if you feel unwell at any point

If You See Someone in Trouble

- **Shout** to attract a lifeguard or teacher's attention immediately — loudly and clearly: "HELP — SWIMMER IN TROUBLE!"
- **Do NOT jump in** to help — alert trained staff only. Untrained rescuers become casualties themselves.
- **Throw** the nearest buoyant object (life ring, kickboard, pool noodle) if the person is near the edge
- If no staff are immediately visible, one person calls 000 while others continue shouting for adult help

000

Emergency: Call 000

Your location: name of pool/school + suburb + street address. What happened. How many people are injured. Whether they are breathing. **Stay on the line.**

I have read and understood the Swimming Carnival Safety Briefing:

STUDENT NAME

CLASS

DATE

STUDENT SIGNATURE



Carnival Day

Teacher Checklist

Complete all pre-carnival checks. Keep this document accessible during the event. Review DE Swimming excursion policy annually.

Pre-Carnival Preparation (1 week before)

- ☐ Confirm venue has qualified lifeguard(s) in attendance for duration of carnival
- ☐ Confirm AED location at the venue — test that it is operational
- ☐ Collect and review all student medical forms (asthma, cardiac, epilepsy, allergies)
- ☐ Identify students who cannot swim or have water anxiety — assign buddy and inform all supervising staff
- ☐ Brief all supervising staff on emergency procedures and their roles
- ☐ Confirm first aid kit is stocked and present on the day
- ☐ Distribute student safety briefing sheet — collect signed acknowledgements
- ☐ Complete and file the DE risk management documentation
- ☐ Confirm student-to-supervisor ratios comply with DE requirements
- ☐ Identify emergency evacuation routes at the venue

Supervision Ratios (DE Policy)

- Check current DE Swimming Policy for approved ratios
- At minimum: one qualified first aider must be present at all times
- Designated Water Watcher: one adult whose sole responsibility is scanning the water — no other tasks
- Rotate water watcher role every 15–20 minutes to maintain vigilance

Venue Layout — Fill In On Arrival

AED location: _____

First aid room: _____

Lifeguard station: _____

Emergency exit: _____

Venue phone: _____

- Never leave pool area unsupervised even momentarily

[DE Swimming Policy 2](#)

Pool address (for 000): _____

Staff Roles on Carnival Day

Event Coordinator

- Overall oversight of running order
- Liaises with venue staff
- Manages timetable and results
- Point of contact for parents

Water Watcher

- Scans the water continuously
- No other tasks while watching
- Rotates every 15–20 min
- Calls 000 or signals lifeguard if needed

First Aider

- Trained and qualified staff only
- Knows AED location
- Manages medical kit
- Responds immediately if called

On-the-Day Checklist (morning of carnival)

- ☐ Roll call — confirm all students present and accounted for

- ☐ Collect any new medical information from parents on arrival

- ☐ Brief all students with the Safety Briefing sheet (or read aloud)

- ☐ Walk venue — confirm AED, first aid room, emergency exits are accessible

- ☐ Confirm lifeguard is on deck and briefed on school group

- ☐ Assign Water Watcher — brief on role and rotation

- ☐ Confirm non-swimmers are identified with coloured caps or wristbands

- ☐ Run brief DRS ABCD refresher with student helpers/water safety monitors

If an Incident Occurs

1. **SHOUT for the lifeguard** — they are the first responder in a pool environment
2. **Clear the pool** — all other students out of water immediately
3. **Call 000** — one designated person only; others manage the crowd
4. **Begin DRS ABCD** if lifeguard is not immediately available
5. **Send someone to the entrance** to guide emergency services in
6. **Notify school administration** as soon as emergency services are en route

7. **Do not move the casualty** unless they are in immediate further danger

8. **Document everything** — time, observations, actions taken — as soon as incident is stable

✓ **Post-Carnival Obligations**

- Complete a written incident report for ANY first aid treatment (including minor)
- Notify school administration of any incidents on the same day
- Serious incidents must be reported to DE — follow your school's Critical Incident protocol
- Debrief with supervising staff — identify any improvements for next year
- Return risk management documentation to the office
- Reference: [DE Swimming and Water Safety Education Policy 7](#)



Emergency Reference Card

Print at A4 and laminate. Post at poolside and first aid station. Accessible to all staff.

000

Emergency Services — Call 000

Pool name: _____ | Street: _____ | Suburb: _____

Tell them: location, what happened, number of casualties, whether breathing. **Stay on the line.**

DRS ABCD — Emergency Action Plan

D

DANGER

R

RESPONSE

S

SEND 000

A

AIRWAY

B

BREATHING

C

CPR

D

DEFIB

CPR: 30 chest compressions + 2 rescue breaths. Hard and fast, 100–120 bpm, 5–6cm depth. Continue until ambulance arrives.

Pool Incident — Immediate Steps

1. Shout for lifeguard immediately
2. Clear the pool of all students
3. Call 000
4. Lifeguard/first aider begins DRS ABCD
5. Send person to entrance for ambulance
6. Keep bystanders clear
7. Do not move casualty unless in danger

Key Contacts — Fill In Before Carnival

Lifeguard name: _____

Lifeguard mobile: _____

Teacher in charge: _____

TIC mobile: _____

School office: _____

AED location: _____

AED (Defibrillator) — How to Use

1. **Ensure the casualty is out of the water** and lying on a dry surface before using
2. Turn on the AED — it will give voice instructions; follow them exactly

3. Attach the pads as shown in the diagram on the pads themselves
4. Stand clear when the AED analyses the heart rhythm
5. If a shock is advised, ensure no-one is touching the casualty, then press the shock button
6. Continue CPR between AED instructions until ambulance arrives

AEDs are safe — they will only deliver a shock if the heart needs it.

Throw, Don't Go — Rescue Hierarchy

1. **Talk** — call instructions from poolside: "Float on your back! Raise your arm!"
2. **Reach** — extend a kickboard, pool noodle, or pole from the edge
3. **Throw** — throw the life ring or any buoyant object with a line attached
4. **Go** — enter the water **ONLY** if lifeguard-trained, never alone, always with flotation

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